FREE SAMPLE • STEP 3 OF 7

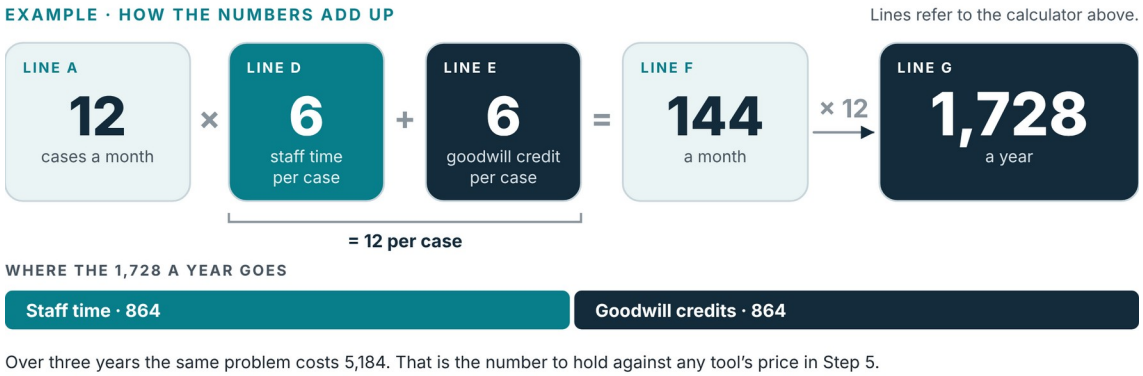
Put a Price on the Problem

Before you compare tools, find out what the problem costs you today. Use one real problem from your business and your own currency. A rough number is enough.

The problem I am pricing: _____

Line	Question	Your number
A	How many times does this problem happen each month?	
B	How many minutes of staff time does each case take to fix or redo?	
C	What does one hour of that staff time cost?	
D	Staff cost per case: B ÷ 60 × C	
E	Other cost per case: refunds, credits, lost sales, rush fees	
F	Monthly cost: A × (D + E)	
G	Yearly cost: F × 12	

Worked example. A booking business has 12 double-bookings a month. Each takes 45 minutes to fix, staff time costs 8 an hour, and goodwill credits average 6 a case.



Over three years the same problem costs 5,184. That is the number to hold against any tool's price in Step 5.

What does that number tell you?

Is line G bigger or smaller than the tools I am considering? _____

_____

Which numbers are estimates (mark them "est.")? _____

_____

THIS IS STEP 3 OF 7
The full workbook walks you from this number to a decision: choose the right problem, map what really happens, improve the process first, pick the simplest adequate fix, and finish with a one-page Workflow Action Brief you can hand to a vendor or developer. Before You Buy Software: A 60-Minute Workflow Workbook, by Jameson Yao, D&P Systems.